CTH 407 – the HPM editor's translation (rank 3; consult after drafting)

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§1

1 According to Pulisa, [man of …] | [When the king] attacks an enemy [lan]d
3 and [re]turns [from the enemy border,]
4 [if] either some male deity [or female deity is angry]
5 [and (as a result)] a plague occur[s among(?)] the people, | [I do the following:]

§2

7 While he [is] re[turning] from the enemy border,
8 they pick one (war) captive and one woman of the (enemy's) land.
9 [On which(ever) road] the ki[ng] came from the land of the enemy,
10 the king s[tands] on that road. | All of the lords stand with him.
12 They bring the captive and the woman before him.
13 He removes the garments from his body. | They put them on the man.
15 But on the woman they [put] the garments of a woman.
16 To the man the king says as follows—
17 if it is [not] convenient for the king, the he sen[ds] another
18 and that one takes care of the ritual— | that one [sa]ys [to] the man as follows:

20 “If some male god of the enemy land has caused this plague,
21 I have j[us]t given to him an adorned man as a substitute.
22 This o[ne is gr]eat with respect to his head, this one is great with respect to his heart, and this [one is gr]eat with respect to his limb.
23 You, male deity, be [pla]cated [with] th[is] adorned man.
24 Tu[rn agai]n in friendship to the king, the [lords], the ar[my, and to] the land of Hatti.
25 [...] but [let] this prisoner be[ar] the plague
26 and [tr]ansport (it) back[into the land of the enemy.]”

§3

27 He speak[s t]o the woman as well in the same way in case the dei[ty] is f[emale].

§4

28 Thereafter, [they drive in] one bull [and] one e[we] | [and ... of] the same enemy [l]and.
30 His (the bull’s) ears [are] ringed [...]. | [...] he/[th]ey [...]
32 He dra[ws] forth red wool, yellow-green wool, bla[ck] wool, [white wool ...] from the king’s mouth.
33 [He says as follows:]
34 “Because the king kept becoming blood[-red, yellow-green, b]lack, [and white ...],
35 [let th]at [...] back to the land of the en[emy]
36 and [with respect to] the person of [the king], the lords, the inf[antry, and the cha]riot[ry do not] take notice,
37 (but) take notice of the land of the enemy!” | [...] he takes. | And to/for wheat [...]
40 The ringed bull [they bring] | [and] he [s]ays[as follows]:
42 “The god [of] the enem[y] who [caused this plague],
43 if he is a male god, to you I have gi[ven] an [ado]rned, ringed, and powerful(?)1 bull.
44 You, O male god, be pacified.
45 Let [th]is bull carry [this plague] back into the land of the enemy.
46 [Turn again in friendship to the king, to the prin]ces, the lords, the army and to the la[nd of Hatti].”

§5

47 Afterwards, he speaks (regarding) the ado[rned] ewe [also in the same way] in case the deity is female.

§6

48 Then the ringed bull [and the ewe are made to] run in front [of the captive] and the woman.

§7

49 Then afterwards [...].

§8'

50 Who [...] | [...] from/with [...] | [...] he transports [...] | good [...], the[n ...]

Colophon

54 [...] On the tablet [are prepared] two rituals | [One ritua]l of Puliša [...]

56 [... one ritu]al of Ummaya [...]

Notes

- §2:1: TI written over an erasure.
- §4:2: Approximately four erased signs.
- §4:3: -a-la- written over an erasure.
- §4:4: Written over an erasure.
- §4:T1: Meaning of mālant- uncertain. Kümmel's suggestion "powerful(?)" tentatively endorsed by CHD.
- §5:5: ŠA DINGIR MUNUS written over an erasure.
- §6:6: GU4 written over an erasure.
- §7:7: -an-ta-ma written over an erasure.
- §7:8: Remainder of the column broken.
- §8':9: A double paragraph stroke follows this line, after which is inscribed the Ritual of Ummaya.
- Colophon:10: -ša written over an erasure.
- T1: Meaning of mālant- uncertain. Kümmel's suggestion "powerful(?)" tentatively endorsed by CHD.